

exacerbated the dearth of available women for men to marry. Meanwhile, widows who remarried were viewed with disapproval by society, because a woman was expected to live a celibate life after her husband's death. Many widows, instead of remarrying or remaining celibate, also chose to commit suicide. Qing emperors tried to ban the practice but were unsuccessful, and so settled for enforcing more stringent rules on who could be martyred.

In the late 19th and early 20th centuries, toward the end of the Qing dynasty, the intellectual classes began to challenge the traditional Confucian view of women and to demand female education. The writer and philosopher Liang Qichao championed the establishment of girls' schools, albeit arguing that a better education would make girls better wives and mothers, and therefore be of benefit to the whole of Chinese society.

▼ "Go" girls

The Qing view of virtue was not limited to sexual behavior. The ancient strategy game *weiqi* was seen by some as a way to avoid gluttony and idleness, so was an approved pastime for Qing women.

